LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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github.com/lvh-data-example | lenavh.dev

PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building, and operating batch and streaming data platforms and cloud data warehouses for e-commerce and payments, including Snowflake warehouse performance and cost optimisation, data quality, dimensional modelling, and reliable batch and streaming pipelines. Focused on reliable, well-tested pipelines, clear data contracts, and trusted analytical warehouses.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Moved transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt (420+ models, tests on every model); nightly run time down from 5h10 to 1h50.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline (Kafka Connect + Snowpipe Streaming) for shipment tracking events, ~30M events/day.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.
- Operate the production data platform through a 1-week-in-6 on-call rotation, diagnosing and resolving pipeline incidents.
- Optimised Snowflake warehouse sizing, auto-suspend settings and unused-table retention, reducing monthly spend from approximately $38K to $24K in 2024.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from PostgreSQL with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile approximately 1.2 TB of daily S3 files against internal ledgers, reducing finance-team month-end reconciliation from approximately 3 days to 4 hours.
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017

Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

OPEN-SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Contributor, community Airflow provider: fixed a pagination bug, added tests, and merged 2 pull requests (2023).
- Speaker, “Data contracts without the hype,” regional data meetup (2024).
- SQL instructor, local Women in Tech meetup, approximately 4 evenings per year since 2021.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations, pytest
Cloud & infra: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions (CI/CD)
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)